SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

5 November 2024 · Shift 1

74 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 16 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 11 questions

Q.2

A class of 42 students took a Physics test. 18 students had an average score of 95. The other students had an average score of 73. What is the average score (rounded off to one decimal place) of the whole class?

(A) 82.4
(B) 79.6
(C) 90.7
(D) 86.1

Q.3

Three numbers are in the ratio 3 : 4 : 5 and their LCM is 2400. Their HCF is:

(A) 25
(B) 40
(C) 30
(D) 60

Q.5

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3500 as a sum borrowed at 6% per year rate of interest for 5 years.

(A) 1090
(B) 1010
(C) 1050
(D) 990

Q.6

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3000 as a sum borrowed at 3% per year rate of interest for 2 years.

(A) 140
(B) 120
(C) 220
(D) 180

Q.8

The average of 8 numbers 127, 432, p, 89, q, 99, 842 and 76 is 221 and the numbers p and q are two-digit numbers. If the units digit of p is one less than that of q and tens digit of q is one less than that of p, then the sum of the digits of p is:

(A) 14
(B) 13
(C) 11
(D) 12

Q.9

Arman leaves ₹2,17,600 to be divided among four sons, three daughters and five nephews. If each daughter receives 3 times as much as each nephew and each son receives 5 times as much as each nephew, how much does each son receive?

(A) ₹25,600
(B) ₹32,000
(C) ₹36,000
(D) ₹18,200

Q.10

When the price of an article was reduced by 10% its sale increased by 60%. What was the net effect on the revenue?

(A) Increase of 24%
(B) Decrease of 44%
(C) Decrease of 24%
(D) Increase of 44%

Q.11

A person marks his goods x% above the cost price and allows a discount of 28% on the marked price. If his profit is 22.4%, then the value of x is:

(A) 50
(B) 30
(C) 70
(D) 80

Q.12

If the radius of a cylinder is decreased by 25% and the height is increased by 25% to form a new cylinder, what is the percentage decrease in new volume (rounded off to two digits after the decimal)?

(A) 40.2%
(B) 39.5%
(C) 27.5%
(D) 29.69%

Q.14

Kumar took a loan from a bank at the rate of 9.5% per annum at simple interest. After 6 years he had to pay ₹3,705 as interest only for the period. The principal amount borrowed by him was:

(A) ₹5,800
(B) ₹2,100
(C) ₹8,200
(D) ₹6,500

Q.15

The milk and water in two buckets P and Q are in the ratio 5 : 3 and 1 : 4, respectively. In what ratio are the liquids in both the buckets mixed to obtain a new mixture in a third bucket R containing 50% milk and 50% water?

(A) 4 : 7
(B) 7 :13
(C) 7 : 9
(D) 12 : 5

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 16 questions

Q.1

In a certain language, ‘this college bag is expensive’ is coded as ‘br od hy jh pb’ and ‘your bag looks very heavy’ is coded as ‘mh sa tn dl od’. How is ‘bag’ coded in the given language?

(A) jh
(B) od
(C) mh
(D) br

Q.2

What will come in the place of ‘?’ in the following equation, if ‘+’ and ‘–’ are interchanged and ‘×’ and ‘÷’ are interchanged? 6 ÷ 3 × 2 + 1 – 2 = ?

(A) 10
(B) 3
(C) 7
(D) 5

Q.3

In a certain code language, ‘sold the painting’ is written as ‘ju ri gi’ and ‘directors sold business’ is coded as ‘hu fe ju’. How is ‘sold’ coded in that language?

(A) hu
(B) ju
(C) fe
(D) ri

Q.4

11 is related to 127 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 8 is related to 70. To which ofthe following is 14 related, following the same logic? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbersinto its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /subtracting /multiplying etc., to 13 canbe performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3is not allowed.)

(A) 240
(B) 217
(C) 202
(D) 194

Q.5

In the following number-pairs, the second number is obtained by applying certain mathematical operations to the first number. Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) 18, 37; 22, 45

(A) 27, 59
(B) 25, 57
(C) 24, 72
(D) 26, 53

Q.6

E, F, G, H, I and J are sitting around a round table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). F is sitting to the immediate left of G and immediate right of E. J is sitting to the immediate right of H and immediate left of I. H is sitting to the immediate right of G. Who is sitting to the immediate left of E?

(A) I
(B) H
(C) J
(D) F

Q.8

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: •Some mats are yolks. •Some toys are mats. Conclusions: (I)Some mats are jute. (II)Toy is a yolk.

(A) Both conclusions (I) and (II) follow
(B) Only conclusion (II) follows
(C) Only conclusion (I) follows
(D) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows

Q.9

MKQO is related to TRXV in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, KIOM is related to RPVT. To which of the following is HFLJ related, following the same logic?

(A) MOSQ
(B) MOQS
(C) OMSQ
(D) OMQS

Q.10

In a certain code language, ‘listen to music’ is written as ‘fd si lr’ and ‘you should listen’ is writtenas ‘lr ep wi’. How is ‘listen’ writtenin the given language?

(A) ep
(B) fd
(C) lr
(D) wi

Q.11

Read the given statement(s) and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statement(s). Statements: Some pillows are curtains. No curtain is a bedsheet. Conclusions: (I) All pillows can never be bedsheets. (II) Some curtains are not pillows.

(A) Only conclusion II follows.
(B) Both conclusions I and II follow.
(C) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.
(D) Only conclusion I follows.

Q.13

In a certain code language, ‘quip area flash’ is coded as 'er to pg' and ‘bacon quip bonus’ is coded as ‘to my te’. How is ‘quip’ coded in the given language?

(A) er
(B) pg
(C) to
(D) my

Q.14

What will come in the place of the question mark (?) in the following equation, if ‘+’ and ‘–’ are interchanged and ‘×’ and ‘÷’ are interchanged? 31 × 961 ÷ 155 – 73 + 54 = ?

(A) 24
(B) 42
(C) 44
(D) 22

Q.17

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 6 ,7, 9, 13, 21, ?

(A) 37
(B) 38
(C) 39
(D) 40

Q.18

JK 3 is related to MH 6 in a certain way. In the same way, OD 11 is related to RA 14. To which of the following is RD 14 related, following the same logic?

(A) UA 17
(B) UZ 17
(C) UA 14
(D) UB 19

Q.19

A, C, F, E, B, U and P are sitting around a circular table facing away from the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). F is sitting third to the right of E. P is sitting third to the left of A. U is sitting third to the right of C. E is an immediate neighbour to the left of P. C is not an immediate neighbour of P. Who among the following is sitting third to the right of U?

(A) E
(B) B
(C) P
(D) A

Q.20

Find the missing term in the following series: MM, LO, KQ, __, IU, HW.

(A) JS
(B) JP
(C) KS
(D) KP

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1
Indian classical vocalist and Padma Vibhushan awardee Kishori Amonkar belongs to which of the following gharanas?

(A) Mewati gharana
(B) Agra gharana
(C) Jaipur gharana
(D) Indore gharana

Q.2
Kathakali, one of the classical dance forms, is performed primarily in which state of India?

(A) Tamil Nadu
(B) Andhra Pradesh
(C) Kerala
(D) Punjab

Q.3
Who was appointed as the governor of Bengal by Sultan Balban after the revolt and subsequent death of Tughril Beg?

(A) Zafar Khan
(B) Mahmud Khan
(C) Bughra Khan
(D) Khizr Khan

Q.4
In which year did Roshan Mistry become the first Indian woman to win an Asian Games medal when she took the silver in the 100-m sprint?

(A) 1954, Asian Games
(B) 1958, Asian Games
(C) 1951, Asian Games
(D) 1962, Asian Games

Q.5
In 1973, the first female high court judge of India Anna Chandy published her autobiography _____ in Malayalam.

(A) The Race of My Life
(B) The Test of My Life
(C) Playing it My Way
(D) Atmakatha

Q.6
Which of the following languages was used by the Sangam poets for composing the texts?

(A) Malayalam
(B) Tamil
(C) Telugu
(D) Kannada

Q.7
According to the National Multidimensional Poverty Index of India: A Progress Review 2023, which of the following states has the LOWEST percentage of population being multidimensionally poor?

(A) Manipur
(B) West Bengal
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Sikkim

Q.8
The religious festival, 'Easter' is celebrated by which community?

(A) Jain community
(B) Parsi community
(C) Christian community
(D) Muslim community

Q.9
Which of the following organisations was established in Bombay by Atmaram Pandurang?

(A) Veda Samaj
(B) Prarthana Samaj
(C) Satya Sodhak Samaj
(D) Poona Sarvajanik Sabha

Q.10
Which of the following location has NOT been selected for setting up the seven PM Mega Integrated Textile Region and Apparel (PM MITRA) Park for the textile sector announced by the Government of India in March 2023?

(A) Gujarat
(B) Karnataka
(C) Maharashtra
(D) West Bengal

Q.11
Sedimentary rocks are formed by the process of deposition and compaction of fragments of rocks of various sizes. This process is called:

(A) weathering
(B) lacoliths
(C) lithification
(D) liquefaction

Q.12
Who received 'Sangeet Natak Akademi' award 2022 for his/her contribution in the field of Kathak?

(A) Jagdish Gangani
(B) Shobha Koser
(C) Rajendra Gangani
(D) Nalini and Kamalini Asthana

Q.13
Which of the following features of the Indian Constitution is added by the 97th Constitutional Amendment Act?

(A) Cooperative Societies
(B) Elections to the Panchayats
(C) Foreign Policy
(D) Independent Bodies

Q.14
Who among the following assumed the position of Central Vigilance Commissioner (CVC) in May 2023?

(A) Rajeev Sinha
(B) Amitabh Kant
(C) Praveen Kumar Srivastava
(D) Rajiv Gauba

Q.15
Which of the following is a NOT a natural fibre crop grown in India?

(A) Hemp
(B) Polyester
(C) Cotton
(D) Jute

Q.16
As per National Multidimensional Poverty Index report 2023, what is the poverty rate of India (2019-21)?

(A) 15.47%
(B) 20.89%
(C) 14.96%
(D) 20.61%

Q.17
Select the correct order of the following metals in terms of their increasing reactivities.

(A) Au, Cu, Mg and K
(B) Au, Mg, Cu and K
(C) K, Cu, Mg and Au
(D) K, Mg, Cu and Au

Q.18
The elliptical shapes in temple architecture in Dravidian style are known by which of the given terms?

(A) Ayatasra
(B) Nasi
(C) Vrita
(D) Gajaprishta

Q.19
Which of the following groups of plants are categorised as cryptogams?

(A) Thallophyta and Gymnosperms
(B) Pteridophyta and Angiosperms
(C) Bryophytes and Thallophyta
(D) Gymnosperms and Angiosperms

Q.20
In which year was the Shri Mahila SEWA Sahakari Bank established?

(A) 1975
(B) 1972
(C) 1971
(D) 1974

Q.21
What is denatured alcohol?

(A) Pure Methanol
(B) Propanol
(C) Ethanol mixed with little methanol
(D) Pure Ethanol

Q.22
What is the meaning of the term 'drop shot' in tennis?

(A) A shot played softly and close to the net
(B) A shot that hits the lines on the court
(C) A powerful service
(D) A powerful overhead shot

Q.23
Which physical feature of India is known for its lateritic soil which supports plantation crops?

(A) Chhota Nagpur Pleateau
(B) Malabar Coast
(C) Western Ghats
(D) The Himalayas

Q.24
Where was the India House established to work for India’s liberation from British possession?

(A) London
(B) Kabul
(C) Berlin
(D) San Francisco

English Language and Comprehension 23 questions

Q.2
The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an error. I regret / in notify that / the model you want/ is out of stock.

(A) is out of stock
(B) I regret
(C) the model you want
(D) in notify that

Q.3
Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select ‘No improvement required’. When Shina reached the bus stand, she realised that “she has left her wallet” at home.

(A) she leaves her wallet
(B) she had been left her wallet
(C) No improvement required
(D) she had left her wallet

Q.4
Select the option that correctly rectifies the underlined spelling error. He received an “honarary” degree for his contributions.

(A) Honnary
(B) Honnorary
(C) Honorary
(D) Honnaary

Q.5
From the given options, identify the sentence which is in the positive degree.

(A) They are playing hockey with longer sticks.
(B) She is the most beautiful girl of the class.
(C) His brother is an intelligent boy.
(D) I have a greater idea in this regard.

Q.6

Select the option that has an error in the usage of the present perfect tense.

(A) Ravi has completed his project.
(B) I have completed my task.
(C) Rashi has completed her homework.
(D) Ravi has complete his homework.

Q.7

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Through thick and thin

(A) To possess both thick and thin clothes
(B) To travel through thick and thin clouds
(C) To pass through thick and thin air
(D) To be supportive in both good and bad times

Q.8

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Sculpter
(B) Pursuit
(C) Stampede
(D) Almighty

Q.9

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. From contacting our loved ones to buying groceries for our daily needs, mobile phones fulfilled our every requirement during the COVID-19 pandemic. Not only during the pandemic, but mobile phones have also _____ our needs since the time of their invention.

(A) served
(B) annoyed
(C) exasperated
(D) incensed

Q.10

Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Mary appeared for the test. She was “waiting anxiously” for the test result.

(A) jumping through hoops
(B) a piece of cake
(C) hitting the nail on the head
(D) on pins and needles

Q.11

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. As he is not satisfied / with the jury’s decision, / he appeal / in the higher court.

(A) he appeal
(B) in the higher court
(C) as he is not satisfied
(D) with the jury’s decision

Q.13

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains grammatical error(s). At the zoo, a curious child / fed an elephant some peanuts, / while enthusiastic group of the visitors / watched in amazement.

(A) fed an elephant some peanuts
(B) watched in amazement.
(C) while enthusiastic group of the visitors
(D) At the zoo, a curious child

Q.14

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word It is a “betterment” of his work.

(A) Growth
(B) Worsening
(C) Popularity
(D) Improvement

Q.15

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Contaminate

(A) Excel
(B) Clean
(C) Pollute
(D) purify

Q.16

Select the grammatically correct sentence from the given options.

(A) He is famous for all his contributions for weekly magazines.

(B) He is famous for all his contributions to weekly magazines.

(C) He is more famous for all his contributions to weekly magazines.

(D) He is more famous for all his contributions for weekly magazines.

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Sarah said that she hates it when people _____ at her.

(A) stare

(B) stair

(C) star

(D) steer

Q.18

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Skeleton in the cupboard

(A) An interesting and thoughtful fact

(B) An embarrassing and hidden fact

(C) A famous and hidden fact

(D) A popular and known fact

Q.19

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word. The corporator gathered heaps of curses, and his “misdeeds” can never be forgiven by the people.

(A) Consequences

(B) Arguments

(C) Transgressions

(D) Confrontation

Q.20

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the given sentence. The “ambiguous” statement of the leader raised criticism among the public.

(A) Clear

(B) Disorganised

(C) Puzzled

(D) Confusing

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It was Saturday evening last week. My parents and younger sister had (1)_____ to my uncle's house to (2)_____the day. I had stayed back to prepare for a class test. At 5:00 p.m, someone (3)_____the door bell. To my shock and dismay, one of my distant relatives, Mr. Sinha (4)_____ standing with his suitcase. I had to call him in most unwillingly. He was a big bore and nothing less than a chatterbox. I asked his preference (5)____ coffee and tea.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) going

(B) gone

(C) went

(D) go

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It was Saturday evening last week. My parents and younger sister had (1)_____ to my uncle's house to (2)_____the day. I had stayed back to prepare for a class test. At 5:00 p.m, someone (3)_____the door bell. To my shock and dismay, one of my distant relatives, Mr. Sinha (4)_____ standing with his suitcase. I had to call him in most unwillingly. He was a big bore and nothing less than a chatterbox. I asked his preference (5)____ coffee and tea.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) spending

(B) spends

(C) spend

(D) spent

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It was Saturday evening last week. My parents and younger sister had (1)_____ to my uncle's house to (2)_____the day. I had stayed back to prepare for a class test. At 5:00 p.m, someone (3)_____the door bell. To my shock and dismay, one of my distant relatives, Mr. Sinha (4)_____ standing with his suitcase. I had to call him in most unwillingly. He was a big bore and nothing less than a chatterbox. I asked his preference (5)____ coffee and tea.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) rings
(B) ring
(C) rung
(D) rang

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It was Saturday evening last week. My parents and younger sister had (1)_____ to my uncle's house to (2)_____the day. I had stayed back to prepare for a class test. At 5:00 p.m, someone (3)_____the door bell. To my shock and dismay, one of my distant relatives, Mr. Sinha (4)_____ standing with his suitcase. I had to call him in most unwillingly. He was a big bore and nothing less than a chatterbox. I asked his preference (5)____ coffee and tea.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) been
(B) were
(C) is
(D) was

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It was Saturday evening last week. My parents and younger sister had (1)_____ to my uncle's house to (2)_____the day. I had stayed back to prepare for a class test. At 5:00 p.m, someone (3)_____the door bell. To my shock and dismay, one of my distant relatives, Mr. Sinha (4)_____ standing with his suitcase. I had to call him in most unwillingly. He was a big bore and nothing less than a chatterbox. I asked his preference (5)____ coffee and tea.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) around
(B) between
(C) on
(D) among

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(B)**
Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**
Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**		

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(A)**

English Language and Comprehension

Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.7 **(D)**
Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**
Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(A)**
Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(B)**	

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.2 · Answer (A) 82.4

18 × 95 = 1,710 and 24 × 73 = 1,752, so the class totals 3,462 and averages 3,462/42 ≈ 82.4.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 40

The numbers are 3k, 4k and 5k, with LCM 60k = 2400, so k = 40. As 3, 4 and 5 have no common factor, the HCF is k = 40.

Q.5 · Answer (C) 1050

SI = 3,500 × 6 × 5/100 = ₹1,050.

Q.6 · Answer (D) 180

SI = 3,000 × 3 × 2/100 = ₹180.

Q.8 · Answer (C) 11

The eight numbers total 8 × 221 = 1,768 and the six known ones 1,665, so p + q = 103. With p = 10a + b and q = 10(a – 1) + (b + 1), p + q = 20a + 2b – 9 = 103, so 10a + b = 56: p = 56 (and q = 47), whose digits add up to 11.

Q.9 · Answer (B) ₹32,000

If each nephew gets x, the sons get 4 × 5x = 20x, the daughters 3 × 3x = 9x and the nephews 5x. 34x = ₹2,17,600, so x = ₹6,400 and each son gets 5x = ₹32,000.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Increase of 44%

Revenue = price × sales: 0.9 × 1.6 = 1.44, an increase of 44%.

Q.11 · Answer (C) 70

0.72 × marked price = 1.224 × cost price, so the marked price is 1.7 times the cost: x = 70.

Q.12 · Answer (D) 29.69%

$V = \pi r^2 h$, so the new volume is $0.75^2 \times 1.25 = 0.703125$ of the old one: a decrease of 29.6875% ≈ 29.69%.

Q.14 · Answer (D) ₹6,500

P × 9.5 × 6/100 = 3,705, so 0.57P = 3,705 and P = ₹6,500.

Q.15 · Answer (D) 12 : 5

Milk is 5/8 of bucket P and 1/5 of bucket Q. For a half-milk mixture, by alligation P : Q = (1/2 – 1/5) : (5/8 – 1/2) = 3/10 : 1/8 = 12 : 5.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 · Answer (B) od

'bag' is the only word in both sentences and 'od' the only code in both, so bag = od.

Q.2 · Answer (A) 10

After interchanging the signs: 6 × 3 ÷ 2 – 1 + 2 = 9 – 1 + 2 = 10.

Q.3 · Answer (B) ju

'sold' is the only word in both phrases and 'ju' the only code in both, so sold = ju.

Q.4 · Answer (C) 202

Each number is squared and 6 added: $11^2 + 6 = 127$ and $8^2 + 6 = 70$. So $14^2 + 6 = 202$.

Q.5 · Answer (D) 26, 53

The second number is twice the first plus 1: 2 × 18 + 1 = 37 and 2 × 22 + 1 = 45. Likewise 2 × 26 + 1 = 53.

Q.6 · Answer (A) I

Facing the centre, a person's immediate left is the next seat clockwise. The clues give the clockwise order I, J, H, G, F, E, which closes the circle, so I sits to the immediate left of E.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows
Jute is not mentioned in the statements, so I cannot follow; and the toys that are mats need not be among the mats that are yolks, so II does not follow either.

Q.9 · Answer (C) OMSQ
Each letter moves 7 places forward: M → T, K → R, Q → X, O → V and K → R, I → P, O → V, M → T. So H → O, F → M, L → S and J → Q: OMSQ.

Q.10 · Answer (C) lr
'listen' is the only word in both sentences and 'lr' the only code in both, so listen = lr.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Only conclusion I follows.
The pillows that are curtains cannot be bedsheets, so it is impossible for all pillows to be bedsheets (I). The curtains may all be pillows, so II does not follow.

Q.13 · Answer (C) to
'quip' is the only word in both phrases and 'to' the only code in both, so quip = to.

Q.14 · Answer (A) 24
After interchanging the signs: 31 ÷ 961 × 155 + 73 – 54 = (1/31) × 155 + 73 – 54 = 5 + 73 – 54 = 24.

Q.17 · Answer (A) 37
The differences double each time: +1, +2, +4, +8, so the next is +16: 21 + 16 = 37.

Q.18 · Answer (A) UA 17
The first letter moves 3 places forward, the second 3 places back and the number rises by 3: J → M, K → H, 3 → 6 and O → R, D → A, 11 → 14. So RD 14 → UA 17.

Q.19 · Answer (B) B
Facing away from the centre, a person's right is the next seat clockwise. Numbering the seats clockwise with P at 0: E is at 6 (P's immediate left), F at 2 (third to the right of E) and A at 3 (P is third to its left). C may not sit next to P and U is third to its right, so C is at 5 and U at 1, leaving B at 4. Third to the right of U is seat 4: B.

Q.20 · Answer (A) JS
The first letters go back one at a time (M, L, K, J, I, H) and the second letters forward two (M, O, Q, S, U, W): JS.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Jaipur gharana
Kishori Amonkar sang in the Jaipur (Jaipur-Atrauli) gharana, which she learned from her mother, Mogubai Kurdikar.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Kerala
Kathakali, the dance-drama known for its elaborate make-up and costumes, is a classical dance form of Kerala.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Bughra Khan
After crushing Tughril Beg's revolt in Bengal, Balban made his son Bughra Khan its governor.

Q.4 · Answer (C) 1951, Asian Games
Roshan Mistry took silver in the women's 100 m at the 1951 Asian Games in New Delhi, the first Asian Games medal won by an Indian woman.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Atmakatha
Anna Chandy's autobiography is 'Atmakatha' (1973). 'The Race of My Life' is Milkha Singh's, 'The Test of My Life' Yuvraj Singh's and 'Playing It My Way' Sachin Tendulkar's.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Tamil
The Sangam poems, the earliest literature of south India, were composed in Tamil.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Sikkim
In the 2023 review Sikkim had a far smaller share of its people multidimensionally poor in 2019-21 than Manipur (8.10%), West Bengal (11.89%) or Rajasthan.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Christian community
Easter, which celebrates the resurrection of Jesus Christ, is a Christian festival.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Prarthana Samaj
The Prarthana Samaj, a reform society inspired by the Brahmo Samaj, was founded in Bombay in 1867 by Atmaram Pandurang.

Q.10 · Answer (D) West Bengal
The seven PM MITRA parks announced in March 2023 are in Tamil Nadu, Telangana, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh; none is in West Bengal.

Q.11 · Answer (C) lithification
Lithification is the compaction and cementation of deposited sediment into sedimentary rock. Weathering breaks rocks down, and laccoliths are bodies of intrusive igneous rock.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Nalini and Kamalini Asthana
The Sangeet Natak Akademi Awards for 2022, announced in February 2024, gave the Kathak award jointly to the sisters Nalini and Kamalini Asthana. (Jagdish Gangani received it for 2023.)

Q.13 · Answer (A) Cooperative Societies
The 97th Amendment (2011) gave cooperative societies constitutional status: the right to form them in Article 19(1)(c), Article 43B and Part IXB.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Praveen Kumar Srivastava
Praveen Kumar Srivastava, who had been acting Central Vigilance Commissioner, was sworn in as CVC in May 2023.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Polyester
Polyester is a synthetic fibre made from petrochemicals; hemp, cotton and jute are natural fibre crops.

Q.16 · Answer (C) 14.96%
The 2023 review put India's multidimensionally poor at 14.96% of the population in 2019-21, down from 24.85% in 2015-16.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Au, Cu, Mg and K
In the reactivity series potassium is above magnesium, magnesium above copper and copper above gold, so in increasing order: Au, Cu, Mg, K.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Gajaprishta
In Dravidian temple architecture the elliptical (apsidal) shape is called gajaprishta, 'elephant-backed'; ayatasra is the rectangular shape and vritta the circular one.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Bryophytes and Thallophyta
Cryptogams are plants without flowers or seeds: the thallophytes, bryophytes and pteridophytes. Gymnosperms and angiosperms bear seeds.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 1974
The Shri Mahila SEWA Sahakari Bank was set up in Ahmedabad in 1974 by self-employed women members of SEWA.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Ethanol mixed with little methanol
Denatured alcohol is ethanol made unfit to drink by adding a little methanol (often with other substances such as dyes).

Q.22 · Answer (A) A shot played softly and close to the net
A drop shot is played softly so that the ball just clears the net and falls close to it.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Western Ghats
Laterite soils form under heavy rain and high temperatures; in the hilly Western Ghats areas of Karnataka, Kerala and Tamil Nadu they are used for plantation crops such as tea and coffee.

Q.24 · Answer (A) London
India House was set up in London in 1905 by Shyamji Krishna Varma as a base for Indian students and revolutionaries.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.2 · Answer (D) in notify that
'In notify' is ungrammatical; to announce bad news, 'regret' takes the to-infinitive: 'I regret to notify that'.

Q.3 · Answer (D) she had left her wallet
The leaving happened before the realising, so it takes the past perfect: 'she had left her wallet'.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Honorary
The correct spelling is 'honorary'.

Q.5 · Answer (C) His brother is an intelligent boy.
'An intelligent boy' uses the plain adjective, the positive degree; 'longer' and 'greater' are comparatives and 'the most beautiful' a superlative.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Ravi has complete his homework.
The present perfect is 'has' + past participle: 'Ravi has completed his homework', not 'has complete'.

Q.7 · Answer (D) To be supportive in both good and bad times
To stand by someone 'through thick and thin' is to support them in good times and bad.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Sculpter
The correct spelling is 'sculptor'.

Q.9 · Answer (A) served
Phones have 'served', that is met, our needs; the other words are about annoying someone.

Q.10 · Answer (D) on pins and needles
To be 'on pins and needles' is to be anxious while waiting for something: 'She was on pins and needles for the test result.'

Q.11 · Answer (A) he appeal
The subject 'he' needs a verb that agrees with it, here the future: 'he will appeal' (or 'he appeals'), not 'he appeal'.

Q.13 · Answer (C) while enthusiastic group of the visitors
The singular noun 'group' needs an article: 'while an enthusiastic group of visitors watched'.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Worsening
'Betterment' is improvement; its opposite is 'worsening'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Pollute
To 'contaminate' is to make impure: to 'pollute'. 'Clean' and 'purify' are its opposites.

Q.16 · Answer (B) He is famous for all his contributions to weekly magazines.
One contributes 'to' a magazine, and 'more famous' needs something to compare with: 'He is famous for all his contributions to weekly magazines.'

Q.17 · Answer (A) stare
To 'stare' is to look at someone fixedly; 'stair', 'star' and 'steer' only sound or look similar.

Q.18 · Answer (B) An embarrassing and hidden fact
A 'skeleton in the cupboard' is an embarrassing secret kept hidden.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Transgressions
'Misdeeds' are wrongful acts: 'transgressions'.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Clear
'Ambiguous' means open to more than one meaning; its opposite is 'clear'.

Q.21 · Answer (B) gone
The past perfect 'had' takes the past participle: 'had gone to my uncle's house'.

Q.22 · Answer (C) spend
'To' is followed by the base form of the verb: 'to spend the day'.

Q.23 · Answer (D) rang
The story is told in the simple past: 'someone rang the door bell'; 'rung' is the past participle.

Q.24 · Answer (D) was
A singular subject in a past narrative takes 'was': 'Mr. Sinha was standing with his suitcase'.

Q.25 · Answer (B) between
A choice of two takes 'between': 'his preference between coffee and tea'; 'among' is for more than two.

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